Petition to Remove the Current Code Network President

This is a petition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan as the current President of the Code Network club for the year 2025

Definitions

AGM: Annual General Meeting of the club

SGM: Special General Meeting of the club

Coordinator: Leadership role within the 3 key portfolio areas of the club [Events, Marketing, Projects]

Summary of Issues

- Inadequate leadership
  - Did not reach out to sponsors during Harsha's inactivity
  - Did not follow up with Harsha about her lack of involvement
  - Did not provide any form of consequences for Harsha's lack of involvement over the course of 8 months, which has resulted in the club being in a strained financial position
- Inability and unwillingness to properly delegate responsibilities
  - Lack of coordination with the industry liaison over the summer break around industry engagement.
  - No official delegation of Presidential responsibilities to any other members of the Executive while she was away overseas.
- Blocking changes to the constitution after they were discussed openly in an executive meeting
  - Went behind Vice-President and wrote to the Guild, telling them to ignore a motion to change our club's constitution
  - Goes against the Constitution Clause 18.1.2 "By resolution of at least two-thirds (⅔) majority at an AGM and/or GM of the Club"
- Intentionally Pushing out a Biased form
  - Manipulative Wording – Phrases like "true opinions" create pressure to align with a particular viewpoint.
  - Framing the SGM Negatively – The form does not present benefits of holding the meeting, subtly discouraging support.
  - Absence of Counterarguments – No mention of why the SGM might be necessary, directing responses toward rejection.
- Rigging the results of the biased form

    - Deliberately excluded results from the total that were in favour of holding the SGM
    - Swayed the overall vote to be not holding the SGM by removing votes that did not agree with her opinion
    - Shows the lengths she is willing to go to in order to get her way
- Lack of Action in Organizing an SGM for Coordinator Replacements
    - We need to have people filling these positions ahead of the Hackathon and Tech Industry night - our biggest events of the year
    - Even the Marketing Coordinator is on board with having a handover, which the President took no action to organise an SGM

Background

Other executive positions held in the club:

- Subiksha has served as Code Network's
    - Secretary (2022)
    - Developer (2023-2024)
    - President (30/09/2024 - current)

Election as club President:

During the 2024 AGM Subiksha nominated herself for the role of President, as well as Liam D'Souza. Subiksha was not the favoured candidate and lost by a large percentage of the total votes. Liam then stepped down from the role as President shortly after the AGM due to personal commitments, and an SGM was called. Subiksha once again nominated herself for the role of President, however with nobody opposing her, she was the de facto candidate.

ELECTION OF PRESIDENT

	CANDIDATE NAME	NOMINATED BY	SECONDED BY
1	Liam D'Souza	Liam D'Souza	
2	Subiksha Thiyagarajan	Subiksha Thiyagarajan	

Elected candidate for President:

NAME	QUT ID NO.	EMAIL	CONTACT NO.
Liam D'Souza	n11589183		

Above: Screenshot from the 2024 Code Network AGM minutes showing the outcome of the President election

Impacted Parties

These are the parties impacted by Subiksha's actions

- Members of Code Network Executive team
- Members of Code Network

Action Proposed & Requirements

According to the Code Network constitution, to remove a member of the management committee, an SGM is required, which shall be convened after:

"14.1.1. By a resolution passed by a two-thirds (⅔) majority at a GM on the grounds that the person is guilty of conduct detrimental to the interests of the Club"

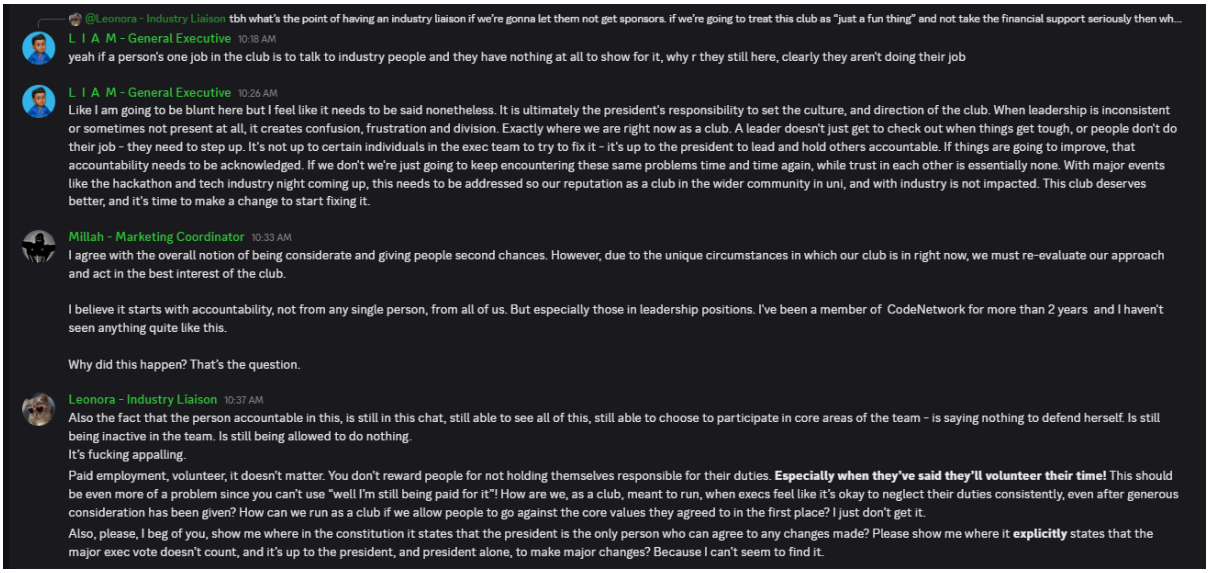
Inadequate Leadership

Explanation

The President's approach to leadership has been notably insufficient. By failing to reach out to sponsors during Harsha's period of inactivity, she has not only forfeited critical opportunities for financial backing but also demonstrated a lack of outward-focused initiative. Additionally, her decision not to take action during Harsha's inaction highlights an avoidance of direct accountability, leaving a gap that could have been filled with proactive leadership. This absence of remedial action or enforcement of consequences for Harsha's underperformance has directly contributed to the club's current strained financial position, setting a troubling precedent for accountability.

Evidence

There was a tense discussion among Code Network Executive Members about leadership failures and lack of accountability. Liam and Leonora criticize the President for not setting direction or enforcing standards, while Millah calls for reflection due to the unusual dysfunction. Leonora also questions the President's authority and the tolerance of inactive exec members, highlighting deeper issues in how the club is run.



@Leonora - Industry Liaison tbh what's the point of having an industry liaison if we're gonna let them not get sponsors. if we're going to treat this club as "just a fun thing" and not take the financial support seriously then wh...

L I A M - General Executive 10:18 AM
yeah if a person's one job in the club is to talk to industry people and they have nothing at all to show for it, why r they still here, clearly they aren't doing their job

L I A M - General Executive 10:26 AM
Like I am going to be blunt here but I feel like it needs to be said nonetheless. It is ultimately the president's responsibility to set the culture, and direction of the club. When leadership is inconsistent or sometimes not present at all, it creates confusion, frustration and division. Exactly where we are right now as a club. A leader doesn't just get to check out when things get tough, or people don't do their job - they need to step up. It's not up to certain individuals in the exec team to try to fix it - it's up to the president to lead and hold others accountable. If things are going to improve, that accountability needs to be acknowledged. If we don't we're just going to keep encountering these same problems time and time again, while trust in each other is essentially none. With major events like the hackathon and tech industry night coming up, this needs to be addressed so our reputation as a club in the wider community in uni, and with industry is not impacted. This club deserves better, and it's time to make a change to start fixing it.

Millah - Marketing Coordinator 10:33 AM
I agree with the overall notion of being considerate and giving people second chances. However, due to the unique circumstances in which our club is in right now, we must re-evaluate our approach and act in the best interest of the club.

I believe it starts with accountability, not from any single person, from all of us. But especially those in leadership positions. I've been a member of CodeNetwork for more than 2 years and I haven't seen anything quite like this.

Why did this happen? That's the question.

Leonora - Industry Liaison 10:37 AM
Also the fact that the person accountable in this, is still in this chat, still able to see all of this, still able to choose to participate in core areas of the team - is saying nothing to defend herself. Is still being inactive in the team. Is still being allowed to do nothing.
It's fucking appalling.
Paid employment, volunteer, it doesn't matter. You don't reward people for not holding themselves responsible for their duties. **Especially when they've said they'll volunteer their time!** This should be even more of a problem since you can't use "well I'm still being paid for it"! How are we, as a club, meant to run, when execs feel like it's okay to neglect their duties consistently, even after generous consideration has been given? How can we run as a club if we allow people to go against the core values they agreed to in the first place? I just don't get it.
Also, please, I beg of you, show me where in the constitution it states that the president is the only person who can agree to any changes made? Please show me where it **explicitly** states that the major exec vote doesn't count, and it's up to the president, and president alone, to make major changes? Because I can't seem to find it.

The President responds by citing academic stress for her absence, asking for empathy instead of directly addressing leadership concerns. She defends Harsha and downplays communication issues, while deflecting criticism from Liam as personal. By pointing to others' lack of attendance and insisting the club is fine, she overlooks broader frustration. Though she calls for proper consultation on decisions, her delay and tone may further erode trust.

Subiksha - President 1:12 PM

@Executive Team apologies for the delayed response—I've been completely locked in an assignment due tonight and haven't slept in two days lol. As fellow students, I hope there's some understanding that sometimes academic priorities have to come first. I do plan to go through everything properly once I've submitted tonight.

Firstly, thank you to everyone who took the time to respond. It's clear we all care deeply about this club, and that passion is something I've always valued. I joined CN at 17 and I'm now turning 21. This club has been a huge part of my uni journey, and I've genuinely enjoyed being here almost every week, making good friends along the way. What's been disheartening to see is how this issue—originating from feeling disrespected by Zac who is newly appointed to the role—has quickly escalated into a sweeping critique of the club's leadership and direction this year. Myself and the previous Vice President have worked closely over the past couple years for this club but like many of you, we've faced personal circumstances that have affected our capacity. So I do ask for some empathy and understanding, especially given everything we've contributed in the past.

To clarify a few things:

- **Regarding Harsha:**

There's been a narrative pushed that she has been inactive for the past six months. That is simply not true. Harsha remained active until just after the last SGM and completed sort of a handover to the new industry liaisons. You are free to scroll up and see for yourself or I'm happy to provide screenshots of those messages if needed. It's not right to criticise her now for failing to do a role when we have just received payment of a $1000 from her sponsor. What hasn't been mentioned is how these massive organisations with full time workers have taken months to pay invoices not mentioning those that have ghosted us.

- **On leadership communication:**

Several people mentioned a lack of follow-up or engagement. To be fair, we did check in with Harsha, and again, we received confirmation that she was okay with continuing on without needing any help. Again I will show those messages after I have submitted by assignment.

- **Regarding Liam's comments**

– I'll say this respectfully, but I was surprised at how directly your comments seemed to single me out. Given that you stepped down from the President role yourself, I'm unsure whether there's some underlying resentment here. It's a fair question given the context. I'd be more than happy to chat privately if that helps clear the air.

- **On the club's state**

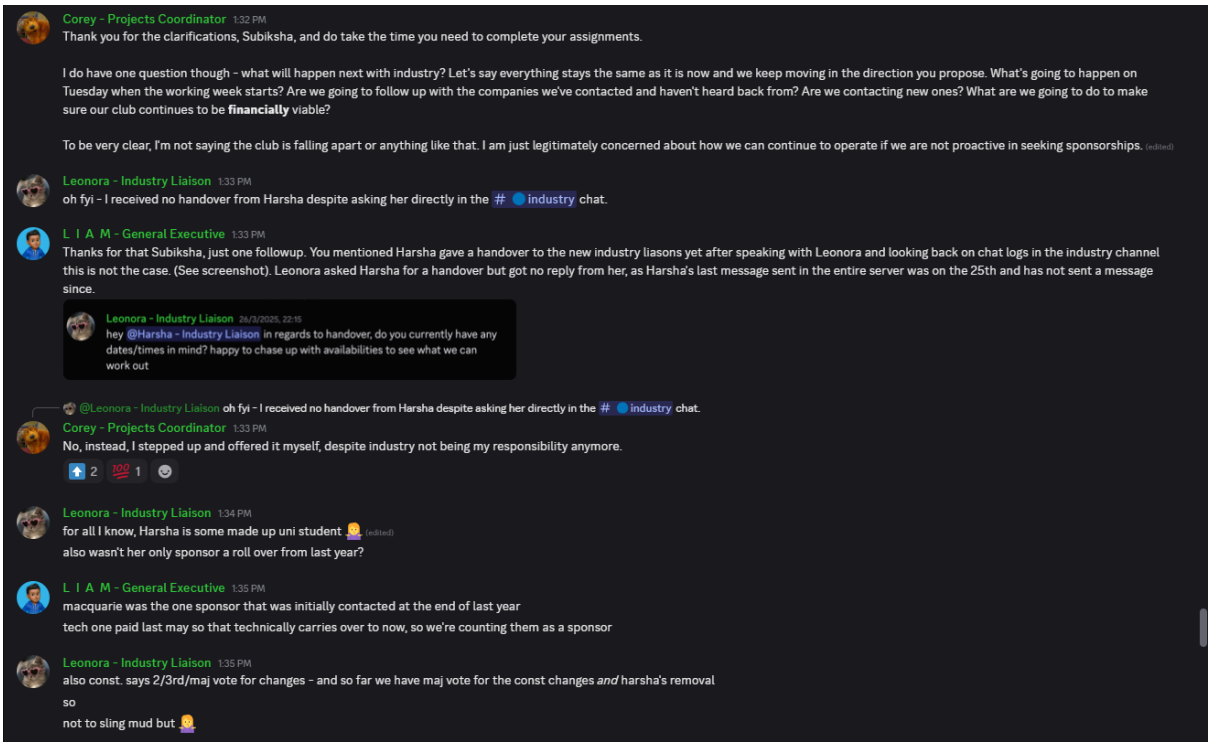
– Some of the messages imply the club is falling apart and has no direction. That doesn't match the reality. We've just had several meetings to plan upcoming major events, **It's surprising that some of the people raising concerns about leadership haven't attended their team meetings themselves.** These are still early months in the year—April just ended—and we've got a long runway ahead for planning and delivery. Events so far have been well-received and successful, which is something we should all be proud of.

With the Survey, Thanks for the reminder. I haven't reviewed them yet, but I'll be sharing them with everyone once I've had a chance.

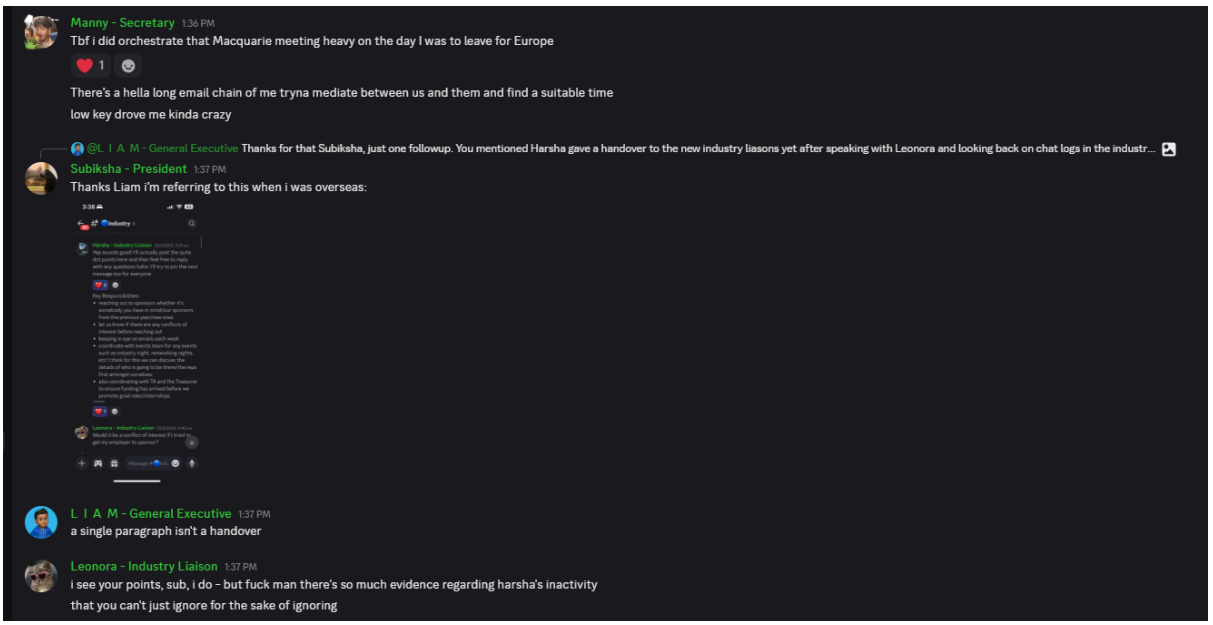
Lastly, on the question of decision-making: while the constitution doesn't explicitly state that only the President can make major decisions, it also doesn't suggest that any subset of execs can force constitutional or leadership changes without wider consultation. Major changes should always involve proper process, respect, and clear communication with the broader team.

I'll follow up in full after my assignment is submitted tonight. Thanks again to everyone for your patience and for the genuine care you're showing for the club. It's great to see us work through this constructively, and together.

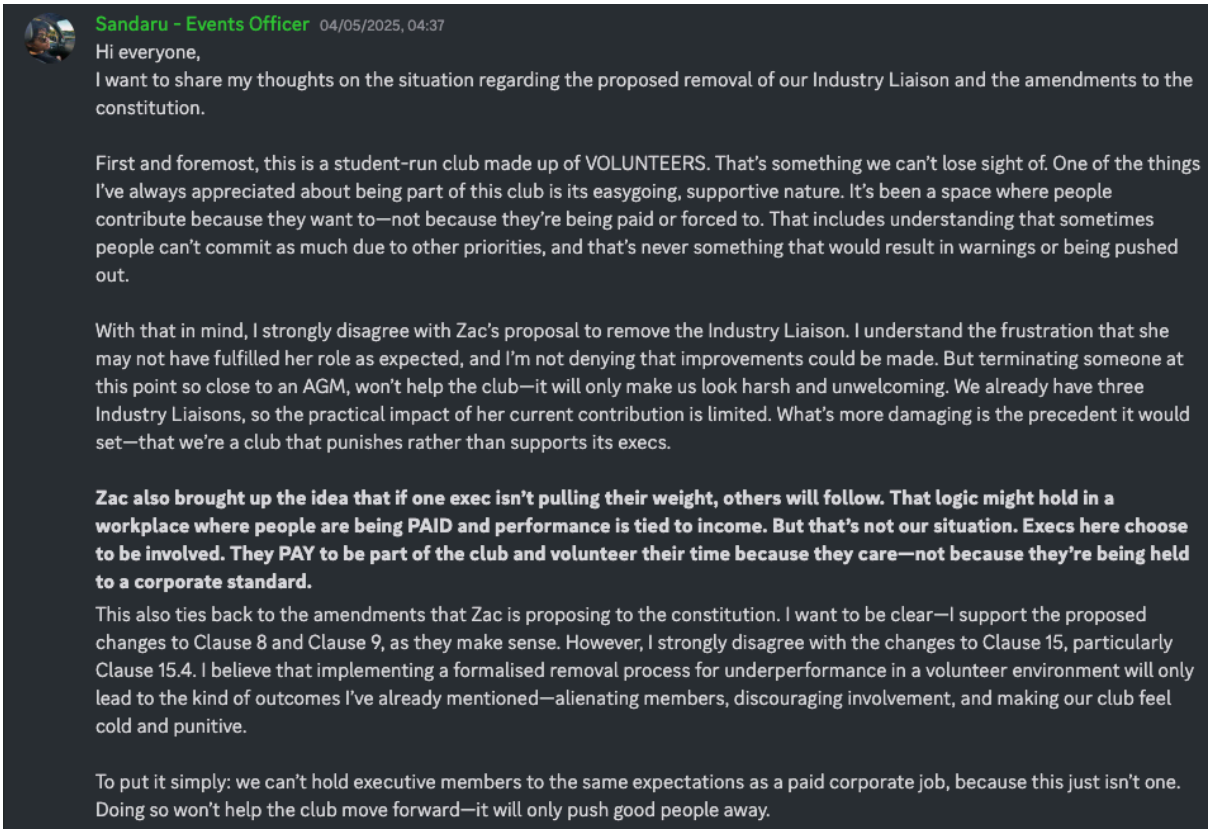
In this exchange, team members dispute the President's claim that Harsha completed a handover. Leonora says she received no response despite asking directly, and Liam backs this with a screenshot showing Harsha's last message was over a week ago. Corey adds that he had to take over industry tasks himself. Leonora questions the legitimacy of Harsha's sponsorship, calling it a rollover from last year, which Liam confirms. She also cites the constitution, noting that major changes—including Harsha's removal—require a majority vote.



Manny begins with their struggle to coordinate a meeting, setting the stage for Liam's frustration over an inadequate handover. The President attempts to defend the process with past correspondence, but it only reinforces Liam's concerns. What emerges is not resolution, but a glaring failure in leadership—responsibility passed along rather than properly upheld.



During the discourse around the proposed motion to remove Harsha, Sandaru (an Events Officer and Subiksha's boyfriend) suggested that Executives simply could not be held responsible for their elected roles and responsibilities.



In response, Corey (Projects Coordinator) posed several questions to the team with regards to the team's leadership and what standards the leadership can be held to by Sandaru's proposal. At the time of writing, Subiksha is yet to respond to Corey's inquiries about Code Network's industry engagement over the summer break.

This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.

Corey - Projects Coordinator 04/05/2025, 09:30

I agree in principle with the points Sandaru has raised, but I have one question - where is the leadership?

What happened over the summer break that we walked away with only one company contacted? Why didn't the President and then-Vice President check in more regularly with Harsha? If Harsha wasn't contacting sponsors, why didn't they step in or ask someone else to step in? **And has the President taken the time to check in with Harsha to enquire as to why she is not engaging with the club as of this moment?**

I raise this because I am concerned about the state of the club financially at the moment. We only have one or two sponsors confirmed right now. Are we going to make it into next year? If not, what do we need to do to keep our club viable?

I get people engage with the exec team on a voluntary basis, but if we don't set any kind of expectations for people and their roles, how will anything ever get done? (edited)

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Corey - Projects Coordinator 04/05/2025, 09:41

I also get that we want to be an easy going society, but the fact is we are still a society that is visible to industry and we need to be engaging with industry. We have people whose sole responsibility is to engage with industry. If they don't do that, then who is responsible?

In response to the Subiksha's response to various concerns over the weekend where she claimed that Harsha had been active and responsible for securing one sponsorship over summer:

Corey - Projects Coordinator 04/05/2025, 13:32

Thank you for the clarifications, Subiksha, and do take the time you need to complete your assignments.

I do have one question though - what will happen next with industry? Let's say everything stays the same as it is now and we keep moving in the direction you propose. What's going to happen on Tuesday when the working week starts? Are we going to follow up with the companies we've contacted and haven't heard back from? Are we contacting new ones? What are we going to do to make sure our club continues to be **financially** viable?

To be very clear, I'm not saying the club is falling apart or anything like that. I am just legitimately concerned about how we can continue to operate if we are not proactive in seeking sponsorships. (edited)

@Corey - Projects Coordinator Thank you for the clarifications, Subiksha, and do take the time you need to complete your assignments. I do h...

Subiksha - President 04/05/2025, 13:39

From the last industry meeting that only Andrew and Zac attended we planned to reach out to smaller brisbane based companies mainly focusing on the hackathon sponserships.

Thats something that i'll be following up with just after my workload clears.

@Subiksha - President Thats something that i'll be following up with just after my workload clears.

Corey - Projects Coordinator 04/05/2025, 13:48

Okay, thank you for clearing that up. I will confess I personally am quite concerned by our financial state given I believe it's a long-standing precedent for sponsorships to be sought during the summer. The fact we have missed this window has been of concern to me for months now.

I trust that once your assignment is done, we will have a clear idea of what the exact next steps are that will be taken to engage with these smaller companies and to seek their support, as well as when these will happen and who will be responsible.

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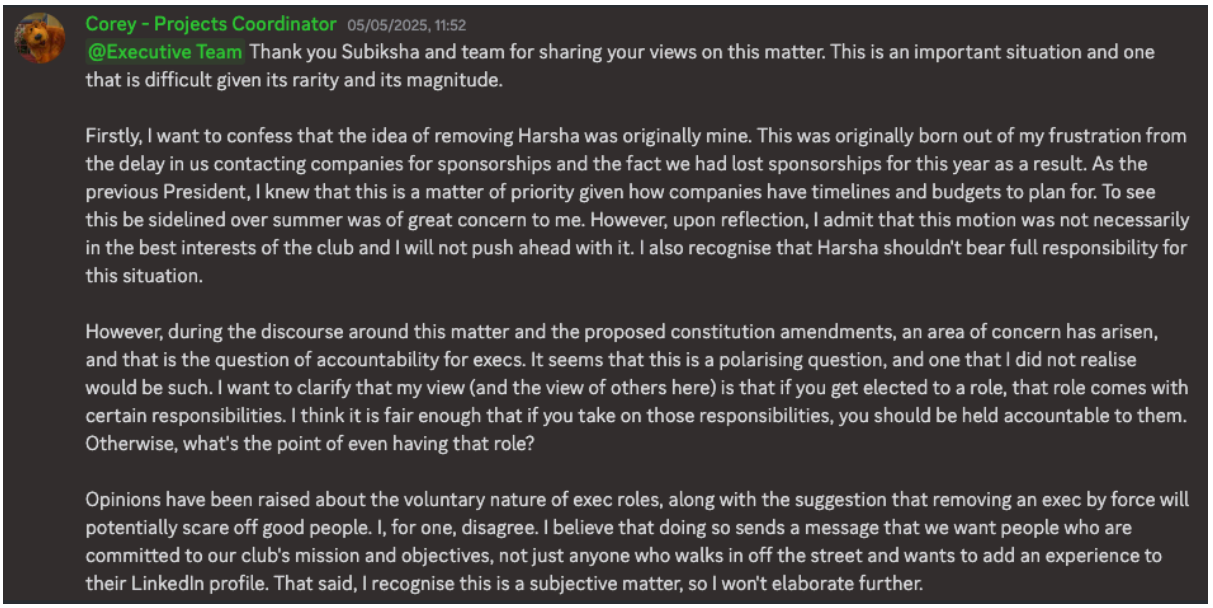
At the time of writing, no such plan or follow-up has been presented, and there has been no further engagement with industry out of the Code Network mailbox.

In relation to the question of her personal accountability, Corey, our Projects Coordinator, pointed to concerns around the lack of leadership relating to our industry engagement, as well as the perceived voluntary nature of team roles. Corey

specifically suggested that the lack of engagement over summer is of concern and should be an opportunity for reflection and growth.



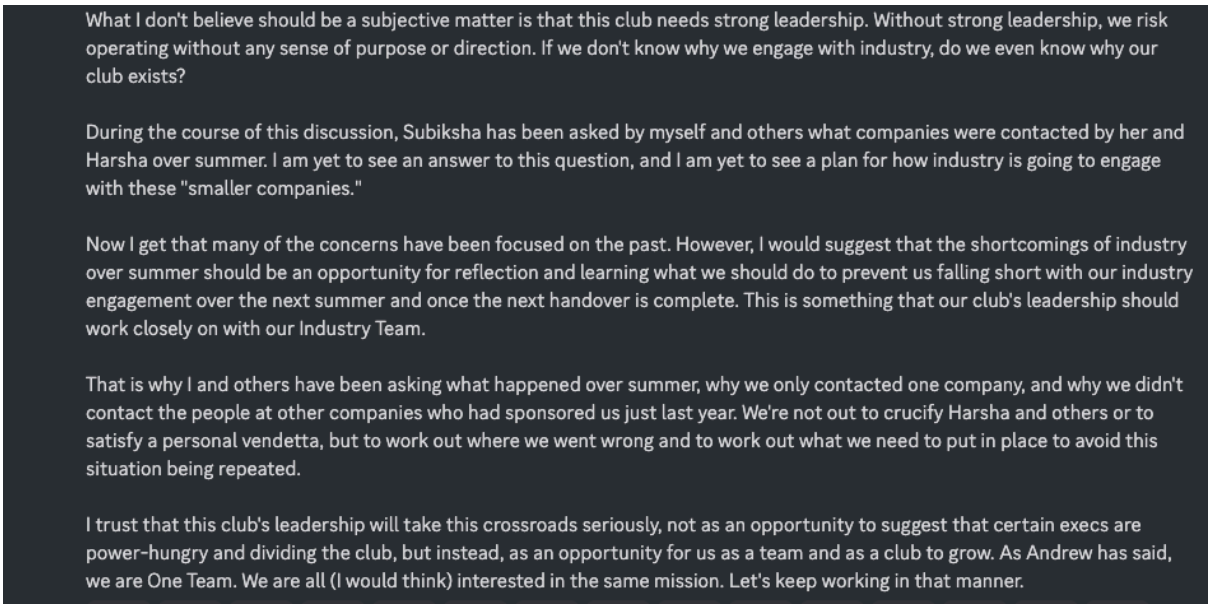
Corey - Projects Coordinator 05/05/2025, 11:52

@Executive Team Thank you Subiksha and team for sharing your views on this matter. This is an important situation and one that is difficult given its rarity and its magnitude.

Firstly, I want to confess that the idea of removing Harsha was originally mine. This was originally born out of my frustration from the delay in us contacting companies for sponsorships and the fact we had lost sponsorships for this year as a result. As the previous President, I knew that this is a matter of priority given how companies have timelines and budgets to plan for. To see this be sidelined over summer was of great concern to me. However, upon reflection, I admit that this motion was not necessarily in the best interests of the club and I will not push ahead with it. I also recognise that Harsha shouldn't bear full responsibility for this situation.

However, during the discourse around this matter and the proposed constitution amendments, an area of concern has arisen, and that is the question of accountability for execs. It seems that this is a polarising question, and one that I did not realise would be such. I want to clarify that my view (and the view of others here) is that if you get elected to a role, that role comes with certain responsibilities. I think it is fair enough that if you take on those responsibilities, you should be held accountable to them. Otherwise, what's the point of even having that role?

Opinions have been raised about the voluntary nature of exec roles, along with the suggestion that removing an exec by force will potentially scare off good people. I, for one, disagree. I believe that doing so sends a message that we want people who are committed to our club's mission and objectives, not just anyone who walks in off the street and wants to add an experience to their LinkedIn profile. That said, I recognise this is a subjective matter, so I won't elaborate further.



What I don't believe should be a subjective matter is that this club needs strong leadership. Without strong leadership, we risk operating without any sense of purpose or direction. If we don't know why we engage with industry, do we even know why our club exists?

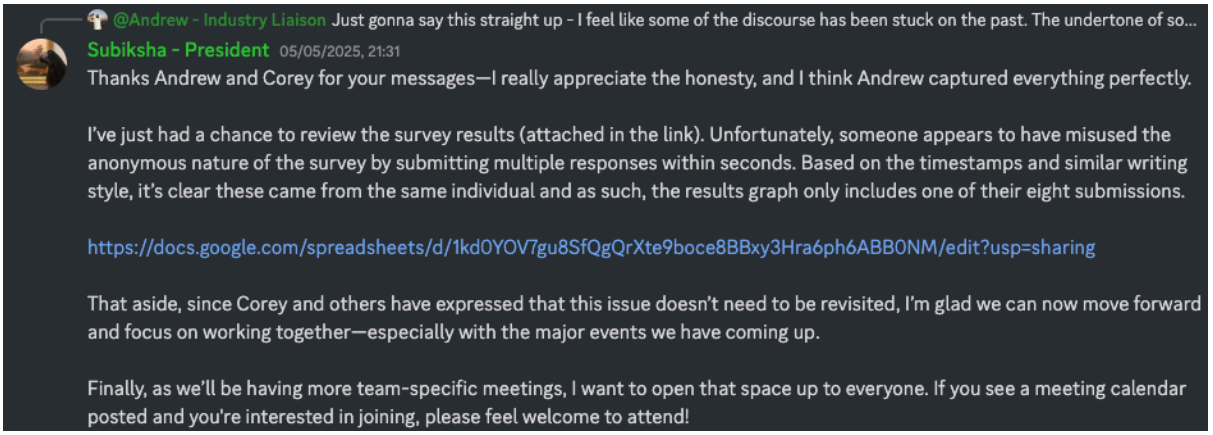
During the course of this discussion, Subiksha has been asked by myself and others what companies were contacted by her and Harsha over summer. I am yet to see an answer to this question, and I am yet to see a plan for how industry is going to engage with these "smaller companies."

Now I get that many of the concerns have been focused on the past. However, I would suggest that the shortcomings of industry over summer should be an opportunity for reflection and learning what we should do to prevent us falling short with our industry engagement over the next summer and once the next handover is complete. This is something that our club's leadership should work closely on with our Industry Team.

That is why I and others have been asking what happened over summer, why we only contacted one company, and why we didn't contact the people at other companies who had sponsored us just last year. We're not out to crucify Harsha and others or to satisfy a personal vendetta, but to work out where we went wrong and to work out what we need to put in place to avoid this situation being repeated.

I trust that this club's leadership will take this crossroads seriously, not as an opportunity to suggest that certain execs are power-hungry and dividing the club, but instead, as an opportunity for us as a team and as a club to grow. As Andrew has said, we are One Team. We are all (I would think) interested in the same mission. Let's keep working in that manner.

Subiksha's response (below) to Corey's message, however, implied that Corey said that "...this issue doesn't need to be revisited." This is categorically false. Although he said the matter of Harsha's removal wouldn't be further pressed, Corey specifically said "...the shortcomings of industry over summer should be an opportunity for reflection..." In disregarding Corey's concerns, Subiksha has demonstrated her unwillingness to hold herself and others accountable for their roles.



@Andrew - Industry Liaison Just gonna say this straight up - I feel like some of the discourse has been stuck on the past. The undertone of so...

Subiksha - President 05/05/2025, 21:31

Thanks Andrew and Corey for your messages—I really appreciate the honesty, and I think Andrew captured everything perfectly.

I've just had a chance to review the survey results (attached in the link). Unfortunately, someone appears to have misused the anonymous nature of the survey by submitting multiple responses within seconds. Based on the timestamps and similar writing style, it's clear these came from the same individual and as such, the results graph only includes one of their eight submissions.

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1kd0YOV7gu8SfQgQrXte9boce8BBxy3Hra6ph6ABB0NM/edit?usp=sharing

That aside, since Corey and others have expressed that this issue doesn't need to be revisited, I'm glad we can now move forward and focus on working together—especially with the major events we have coming up.

Finally, as we'll be having more team-specific meetings, I want to open that space up to everyone. If you see a meeting calendar posted and you're interested in joining, please feel welcome to attend!

Since the posting of this message, there has been no follow-up by Subiksha with regards to industry engagement. That is despite Subiksha claiming that she would be making contact with these "smaller companies" earlier in the discussion.

Impact

Failure to Engage Sponsors During Critical Inactivity:

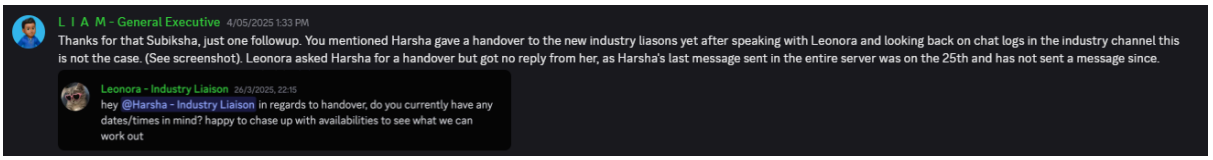
- Missed Opportunities:
  - By not reaching out to potential sponsors during Harsha's period of inactivity, the President allowed a critical window for financial and strategic support to close.
  - Without these sponsorships, the club lost not only immediate funding but also potential long-term partnerships that could provide mentorship, industry connections, and increased visibility.
- Lack of Strategic Outreach:
  - Engaging sponsors is a proactive measure that goes beyond managing internal affairs—it's about building strong external alliances.
  - The absence of this initiative suggests a narrow focus on internal issues without leveraging external resources to bolster the club's prospects.

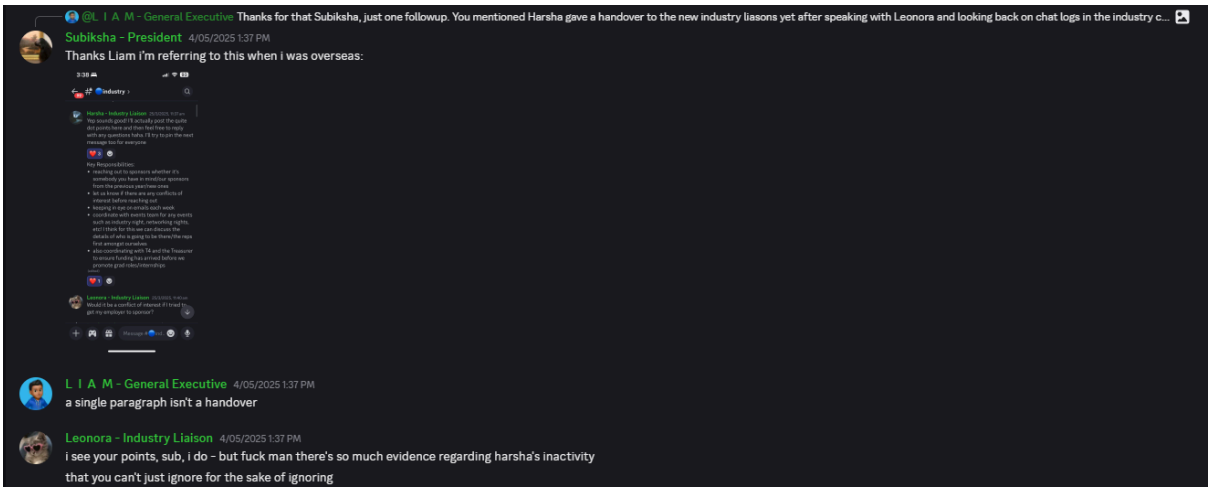
Inability and unwillingness to properly delegate responsibilities

Explanation

The President's handling of responsibilities has been inadequate, marked by a lack of meaningful delegation. Despite clear evidence that key roles required urgent attention, she failed to take the necessary steps to facilitate a structured transition. Rather than ensuring that the Marketing and Events Coordinator roles were properly filled, she did not take action to organize an SGM, leaving the club without a formal process to address vacancies. Additionally, her inaction during Harsha's period of disengagement allowed responsibilities to stagnate, reinforcing a pattern where leadership positions could be neglected without consequence. By failing to implement oversight or ensure executives fulfilled their duties, she created an environment where key functions were either delayed or ignored, placing the club's operations at risk.

Evidence





The conversation highlights the struggle Liam and Leonora faced due to a lack of proper delegation. The President presents an old message in an attempt to justify Harsha's role, but it quickly becomes evident that one paragraph is far from sufficient for a handover. Leonora reinforces the concerns, pointing out Harsha's prolonged inactivity, showing that the issue was not just missing documentation but a complete failure in fulfilling responsibilities. Without structured leadership,

key roles were neglected, leaving the team to navigate the gaps themselves, without the necessary support or transition.

Impacts

The President's failure to take action on leadership transitions has created several challenges:

- Leadership Vacancies: With no SGM held, critical executive roles remain unfilled, leaving responsibilities unclear and increasing workload strain.
- Disrupted Event Planning: The absence of Marketing and Events Coordinators jeopardizes key events like the Hackathon and Tech Industry Night, affecting promotion and logistics.
- Lack of Continuity: Outgoing executives offered to facilitate a handover, but without an SGM, their guidance remains unused, leaving successors unprepared.
- Weak Governance Standards: Ignoring constitutional procedures undermines accountability, setting a precedent where leadership positions can be neglected without consequence.
- Operational Instability: Without structured leadership, sponsorship outreach, financial planning, and engagement suffer, harming the club's long-term stability.
- This inaction has not only delayed leadership decisions but has actively weakened the club's ability to function effectively.

Blocking changes to Constitution

Explanation

In an apparent disregard for transparent and collective decision-making, the President obstructed important constitutional reforms that had been openly discussed during an executive meeting. Rather than working collaboratively, the President chose to bypass the established chain of command by going behind the Vice-President's back to write to the Guild, urging them to ignore a motion aimed at improving the club's governance framework. This unilateral action not only subverts the executive process but creates distrust and undermines the integrity of the club's decision-making processes.

Moreover, since that time, the President has not made any effort to facilitate further conversation or offer a platform to revisit the proposed changes. There has been no opportunity for the Executive Team or the broader membership to engage in a constructive conversation about the reforms. Despite the clear need for collaboration and open communication on such significant matters, the President's lack of initiative to address the concerns surrounding the governance framework suggests a reluctance to genuinely engage with differing perspectives.

Evidence

The President obstructed important constitutional reforms that had been openly discussed during an executive meeting prior on Monday 28/04. The Constitution Section 18 outlines the procedure and what she tried to do was a blatant disregard for club procedure

Subiksha - President 3:06 PM

Thanks Corey for your notes—I agree that there has been some miscommunication recently, and I appreciate you taking the time to address it.

I want to clarify a few things regarding Harsha's role. Over the summer, I did have meetings with her to discuss how we would organise sponsorships. I also attended industry meetings with her and Manny, where we engaged with potential sponsors. While I understand that many current execs joined after the recent SGM, I don't think those earlier contributions should be overlooked. I also want to emphasise that if something personal has affected her recently, I believe that warrants understanding.

For transparency, I want to share where things currently stand:

- The first time I heard about the SGM proposal, constitutional amendments, and termination was during Monday night's meeting
- I stated that I would take time to consider everything and share my thoughts in our full exec meeting on Friday. I also messaged Zac on Discord to confirm this.
- I was surprised to see an email had already been sent to the Guild on Friday morning, with SGM details and proposed constitutional changes—neither myself nor the secretary were aware of it.

I raised this in yesterday's meeting because it's a serious matter. Decisions of this scale should not be made or actioned without team discussion and confirmation—especially when I had already mentioned to revisit it on Friday.

Moving forward, and in line with the club's stated aims and values, I urge us all to prioritise empathy, teamwork, and the long-term interests of our members to reduce complications down the line.

I've also already received interest from execs for the Events Coordinator and Marketing Coordinator roles. I'll begin planning the SGM in the coming weeks for the purpose of those appointments as the guild is waiting for my confirmation which i will send on monday.

Corey - Projects Coordinator 3:21 PM

On a quick note with regards to constitutional amendments, there is no rule to my knowledge that mandates that constitution amendments have to be reviewed by the exec team before being moved at a GM. As a matter of precedent, I moved a series of amendments at the 2023 AGM as a then General Exec and at the 2024 AGM as then President that I do not recall seeking feedback from the team before I sought the Guild's approval. Having said that, it is still a good idea to have these changes reviewed, but it is ultimately up to the club members to decide if amendments should be voted up or down.

Edit: I have checked the Constitution. Section 18 - Alteration of this Constitution - only mandates an amendment is to be approved by the Guild first and then a 2/3 majority at a AGM and/or GM of the Club. (edited)

This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.

Evidence from the Constitution rules below do not state anywhere that alterations to the Constitution do not need the President's approval to be moved at a meeting (AGM/SGM):

18. ALTERATION OF THIS CONSTITUTION

18.1. To be a valid Constitutional amendment, the amendment must be approved by:

18.1.1. The Guild via the CSO or the CC; then

18.1.2. By resolution of at least two-thirds (⅔) majority at an AGM and/or GM of the Club

Code Network <hello@codenetwork.co>

Code Network Constitution Amendments
4 messages

Zac Knight <vicepresident@codenetwork.co> 2 May 2025 at 08:00
To: Guild Clubs <clubs@qutguild.com>

Hi Guild team,

Code Network will be having a Special General Meeting (SGM) on Monday 19/05 to hand over roles for those graduating this semester—and I would like to propose some amendments to our club's constitution ahead of the event.

These amendments are to help clarify the following gray areas:

- Expectations for executives to hold active Code Network memberships
- Responsibilities and duties of executives
- The process for addressing executive inactivity

Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you!

Kind regards,

Zac Knight
Vice President | Code Network

Code Network Constitution - Proposed Amendments for SGM 2025.pdf
223K

Guild Clubs <clubs@qutguild.com> 2 May 2025 at 09:04
To: Zac Knight <vicepresident@codenetwork.co>

Hi Zac,

Thanks for sending this through.

We will take a look at the proposed constitution and let you know if we have any questions.

Will get this back to you next week.

Any questions, please let me know.

Thanks,
Sophie Panagis-Grocott
She/Her
07 3138 1666
clubs@qutguild.com

Clubs Administration Officer
Guild Professional Staff
C Block, Level 2, 149 Victoria Park Road,
QUT Kelvin Grove QLD 4059

This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.

To: Guild Clubs <clubs@qutguild.com>
Subject: Code Network Constitution Amendments

You don't often get email from vicepresident@codenetwork.co. Learn why this is important

[Quoted text hidden]

Code Network <hello@codenetwork.co> 2 May 2025 at 12:40
To: Guild Clubs <clubs@qutguild.com>

Hi Sophie,

Hope you're having a great day so far!

I just wanted to follow up regarding the recent email about the proposed constitutional amendments and the SGM. Our full executive team is meeting later today to discuss this in detail, so I kindly ask that you hold off on reviewing the submitted documents until I've sent a confirmation from my end.

I completely understand you're likely quite busy, so this is just to avoid any unnecessary work in case the team decides not to proceed with the current proposal.

Thanks so much for your time and support.

Kind regards,

Subiksha
President | Code Network

[Quoted text hidden]

Guild Clubs <clubs@qutguild.com> 2 May 2025 at 12:54
To: Code Network <hello@codenetwork.co>

HI Subiksha,

Thanks for letting us know!

We will hold off until we receive your updated email.

Enjoy your weekend.

Thanks,

Sophie Panagis-Grocott
She/Her

07 3138 1666
clubs@qutguild.com

Clubs Administration Officer
Guild Professional Staff

C Block, Level 2, 149 Victoria Park Road,
QUT Kelvin Grove QLD 4059

Available from 8:30am – 4:00pm
KG – Monday to Wednesday
GP – Thursday to Friday

QUT GUILD

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Your Student Union

QUT Guild acknowledges the Turrbal and Yuggera as the First Nations owners of the lands where QUT now stands. We pay respect to their Elders, lores, customs and creation spirits. We recognise that these lands have always been places of teaching, research and learning. QUT Guild acknowledges the important role Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people play within the QUT community.

This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.

Impact

Blocking Changes to the Constitution:

- Disregard for Transparent and Collective Decision-Making:
  - The President actively obstructed constitutional reforms that were openly discussed during an executive meeting on Monday 28/04
  - This behaviour reveals a clear departure from the principle of transparency, as decisions impacting the entire organization should result from collective input and mutual trust.
- Bypassing Established Protocols:
  - Instead of engaging with the leadership team and following proper channels, the President chose to bypass the Vice-President.
  - By writing directly to the Guild, the President neglected to work collaboratively within the established chain of command, which is vital for maintaining unity in decision-making.

Evidence from the Constitution below does not state anywhere that the changes require the President's approval to be moved at a meeting (AGM/SGM):

18. ALTERATION OF THIS CONSTITUTION

18.1. To be a valid Constitutional amendment, the amendment must be approved by:

18.1.1. The Guild via the CSO or the CC; then

18.1.2. By resolution of at least two-thirds (⅔) majority at an AGM and/or GM of the Club

Intentionally Pushing out a Biased Form:

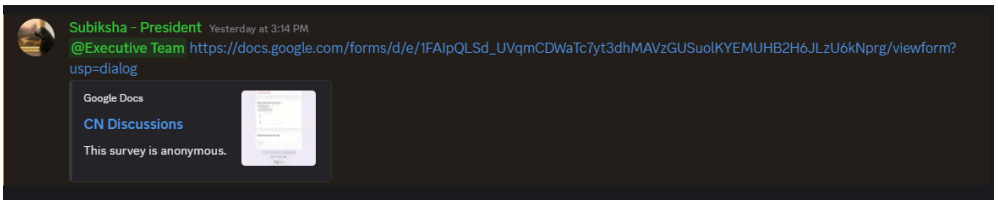
Explanation

The biased form being circulated subtly manipulates responses by framing the Special General Meeting (SGM) in a negative light and steering participants toward rejecting the motion. The wording of the form itself, particularly the phrase "true opinions," suggests that honesty is synonymous with opposition, pushing respondents to feel that saying "no" is the most valid or authentic choice. Additionally, the form fails to present any benefits of holding the SGM, making the decision appear one-sided and discouraging balanced consideration. The emphasis on anonymity may embolden respondents to express stronger opposition than they otherwise would in an open discussion, increasing the likelihood of responses skewing toward rejection.

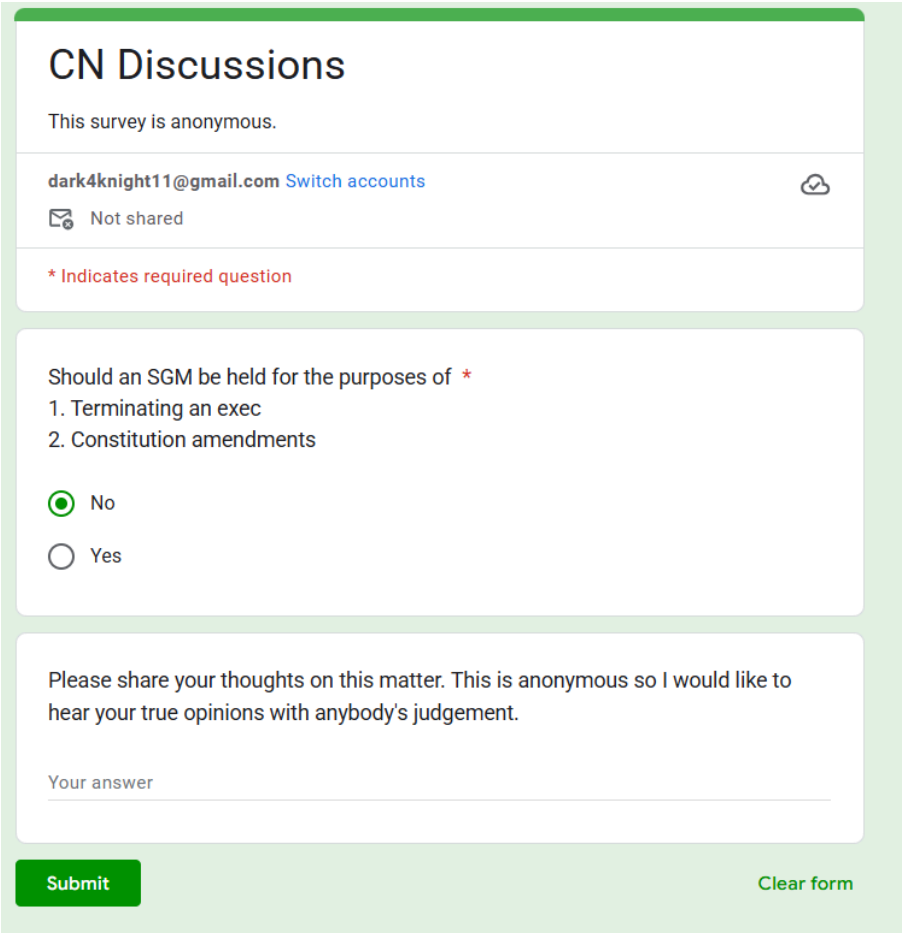
Furthermore, the mandatory nature of the question forces engagement from everyone, including those who may be uninformed or indifferent, which can distort results. There is also evidence of social reinforcement in the phrasing that implies respondents must answer without judgment, potentially encouraging a more extreme stance rather than a nuanced discussion.

The lack of counterarguments—such as reasons why an SGM may be necessary—creates a misleading presentation of the issue, subtly guiding the club toward an outcome that benefits those opposing structural changes. The form is not an objective tool for gathering honest feedback but rather an instrument crafted to tilt the decision in a predetermined direction, raising concerns about transparency and fairness in governance.

Evidence



The form, titled "CN Discussions," created by the President and sent through to the executive team presents itself as an anonymous survey but subtly steers respondents toward a particular outcome. At first glance, it appears to ask for genuine opinions on whether a Special General Meeting (SGM) should be held for executive termination and constitutional amendments. However, the response options—"No" pre-selected—create an immediate imbalance, subtly nudging participants toward rejecting the proposal before even considering it. Beneath this, the prompt encourages open feedback, emphasizing anonymity to elicit honest responses, yet the framing of the question suggests a predetermined stance rather than genuine inquiry. This approach—whether intentional or not—functions less as a neutral survey and more as an attempt to reinforce a preferred outcome under the guise of open discussion.



This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.

Impact

Key Manipulative Elements in the Form

- Framing of the Decision – Presents the SGM in a negative light without acknowledging potential benefits.
- Leading Wording ("True Opinions") – Implies that rejecting the SGM is the most honest response.
- Social Pressure Through Anonymity – Encourages stronger opposition by removing personal accountability.
- Absence of Counterbalance – No arguments supporting the SGM, making rejection seem like the logical choice.
- Encouraging Extreme Responses – Phrasing about "judgment-free opinions" may lead to harsher critiques rather than fair assessments.

Rigging the results of the biased form

Explanation

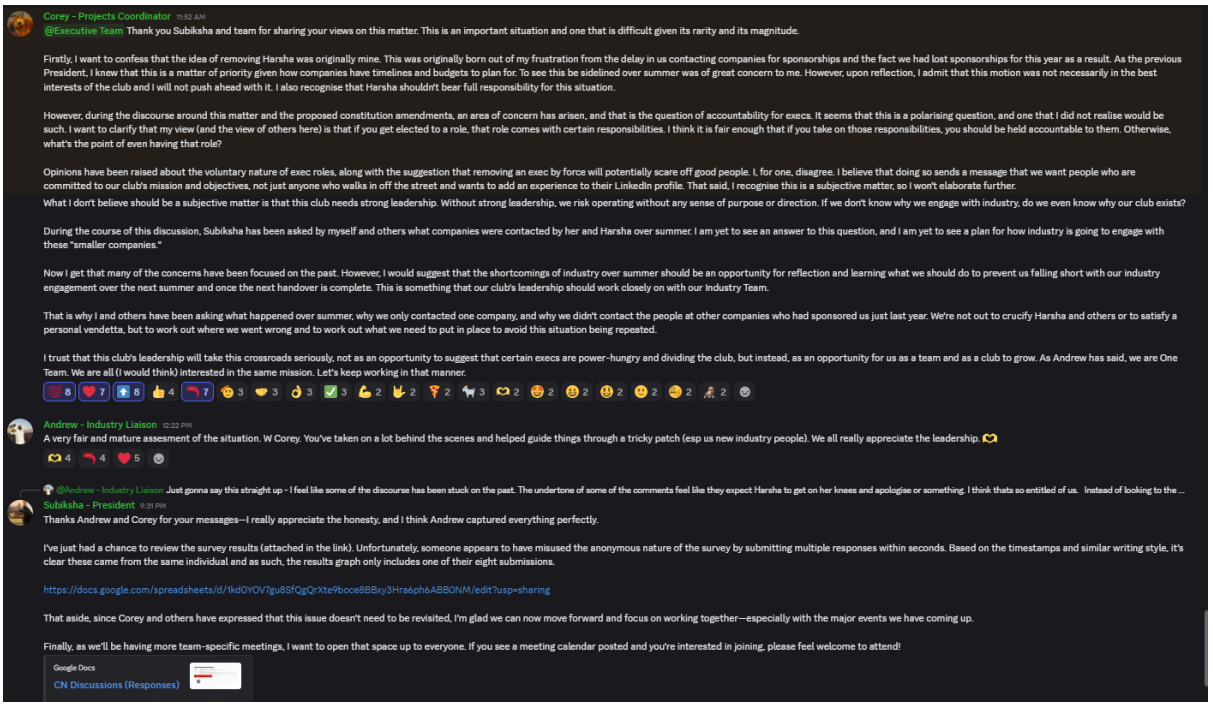
The President's actions have directly undermined the integrity of the club's decision-making process. By rigging the results of a biased form, she not only deliberately excluded votes that supported holding the SGM but also skewed the final outcome to mirror her personal agenda. This manipulation—removing any votes that did not align with her specific viewpoint—significantly distorts the democratic process, effectively silencing dissenting voices within the club. Such actions raise serious concerns about transparency and fairness, as they bypass the fundamental principles of equal representation and impartial decision-making.

The President's actions not only involved rigging the vote by excluding supportive votes, but they also represent a blatant disregard for the Code Network Constitution. In particular, she has ignored section 9.6, which clearly states: "In the event of a position remaining vacant after an AGM or GM, the Executive will have the power to fill those vacancies at an Executive Meeting, subject to ratification by a GM." By bypassing this established procedure, she undermines an essential constitutional safeguard designed to maintain transparency and collective decision-making. Instead of following the process that allows for executive oversight and subsequent ratification by the general membership, her unilateral actions reveal a preference for manipulating outcomes without due accountability.

These tactics demonstrate the extreme lengths to which the President is willing to go in order to secure her desired outcome, even at the expense of the club's ethical standards and democratic values. This behaviour not only erodes trust among club members but also sets a dangerous precedent for future governance. When leadership engages in such underhanded practices, it jeopardises the foundation of collective decision-making, leaving the club vulnerable to further manipulation and potentially fostering an environment where unethical behaviour becomes normalised.

Evidence

Corey's reflection revealed a larger failure in leadership. While he had initially pushed for Harsha's removal, he soon recognized that the deeper issue was a system that had allowed executive roles to exist without real accountability. The President's passive approach had enabled inactivity, turning positions into résumé boosters rather than genuine responsibilities. The absence of industry outreach over the summer was just one example of this broader negligence.



Corey - Projects Coordinator 11:52 AM

@Executive Team Thank you Subiksha and team for sharing your views on this matter. This is an important situation and one that is difficult given its rarity and its magnitude.

Firstly, I want to confess that the idea of removing Harsha was originally mine. This was originally born out of my frustration from the delay in us contacting companies for sponsorships and the fact we had lost sponsorships for this year as a result. As the previous President, I knew that this is a matter of priority given how companies have timelines and budgets to plan for. To see this be sidelined over summer was of great concern to me. However, upon reflection, I admit that this motion was not necessarily in the best interests of the club and I will not push ahead with it. I also recognise that Harsha shouldn't bear full responsibility for this situation.

However, during the discourse around this matter and the proposed constitution amendments, an area of concern has arisen, and that is the question of accountability for execs. It seems that this is a polarising question, and one that I did not realise would be such. I want to clarify that my view (and the view of others here) is that if you get elected to a role, that role comes with certain responsibilities. I think it is fair enough that if you take on those responsibilities, you should be held accountable to them. Otherwise, what's the point of even having that role?

Opinions have been raised about the voluntary nature of exec roles, along with the suggestion that removing an exec by force will potentially scare off good people. I, for one, disagree. I believe that doing so sends a message that we want people who are committed to our club's mission and objectives, not just anyone who walks in off the street and wants to add an experience to their LinkedIn profile. That said, I recognise this is a subjective matter, so I won't elaborate further.

What I don't believe should be a subjective matter is that this club needs strong leadership. Without strong leadership, we risk operating without any sense of purpose or direction. If we don't know why we engage with industry, do we even know why our club exists?

During the course of this discussion, Subiksha has been asked by myself and others what companies were contacted by her and Harsha over summer. I am yet to see an answer to this question, and I am yet to see a plan for how industry is going to engage with these "smaller companies."

Now I get that many of the concerns have been focused on the past. However, I would suggest that the shortcomings of industry over summer should be an opportunity for reflection and learning what we should do to prevent us falling short with our industry engagement over the next summer and once the next handover is complete. This is something that our club's leadership should work closely on with our Industry Team.

That is why I and others have been asking what happened over summer, why we only contacted one company, and why we didn't contact the people at other companies who had sponsored us just last year. We're not out to crucify Harsha and others or to satisfy a personal vendetta, but to work out where we went wrong and to work out what we need to put in place to avoid this situation being repeated.

I trust that this club's leadership will take this crossroads seriously, not as an opportunity to suggest that certain execs are power-hungry and dividing the club, but instead, as an opportunity for us as a team and as a club to grow. As Andrew has said, we are One Team. We are all (I would think) interested in the same mission. Let's keep working in that manner.

Andrew - Industry Liaison 12:22 PM

A very fair and mature assesment of the situation. W Corey. You've taken on a lot behind the scenes and helped guide things through a tricky patch (esp us new industry people). We all really appreciate the leadership.

@Andrew - Industry Liaison Just gonna say this straight up - I feel like some of the discourse has been stuck on the past. The undertone of some of the comments feel like they expect Harsha to get on her knees and apologise or something. I think thats so entitled of us. Instead of looking to the ...

Subiksha - President 9:31 PM

Thanks Andrew and Corey for your messages—I really appreciate the honesty, and I think Andrew captured everything perfectly.

I've just had a chance to review the survey results (attached in the link). Unfortunately, someone appears to have misused the anonymous nature of the survey by submitting multiple responses within seconds. Based on the timestamps and similar writing style, it's clear these came from the same individual and as such, the results graph only includes one of their eight submissions.

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1kd0YOVTgu8SfQgQrXte9boce8BBxy3Hra6ph6ABB0NM/edit?usp=sharing

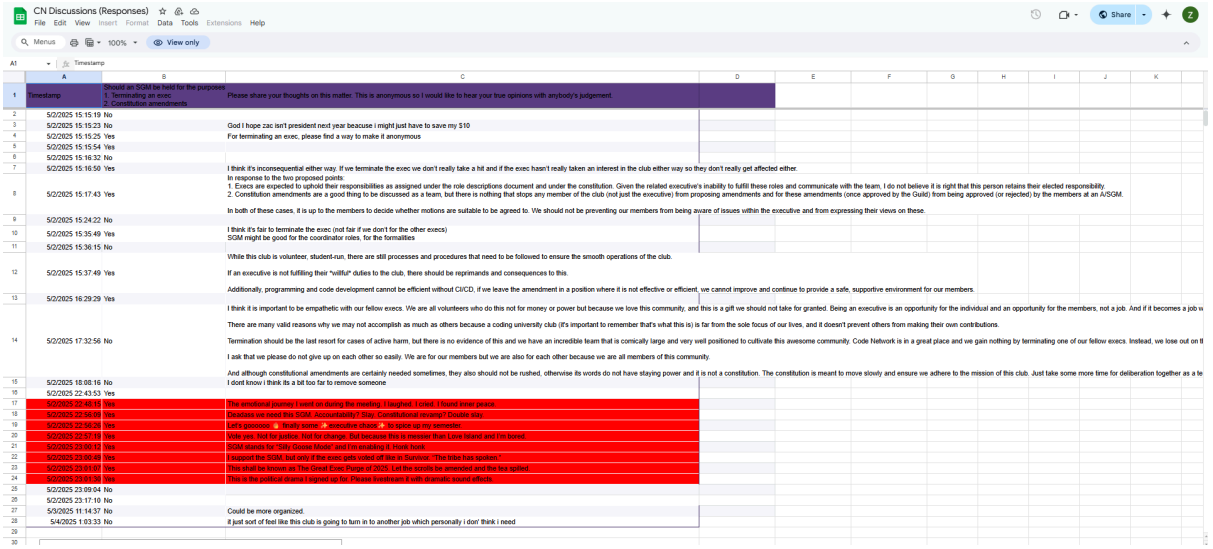
That aside, since Corey and others have expressed that this issue doesn't need to be revisited, I'm glad we can now move forward and focus on working together—especially with the major events we have coming up.

Finally, as we'll be having more team-specific meetings, I want to open that space up to everyone. If you see a meeting calendar posted and you're interested in joining, please feel welcome to attend!

Google Docs

CN Discussions (Responses)

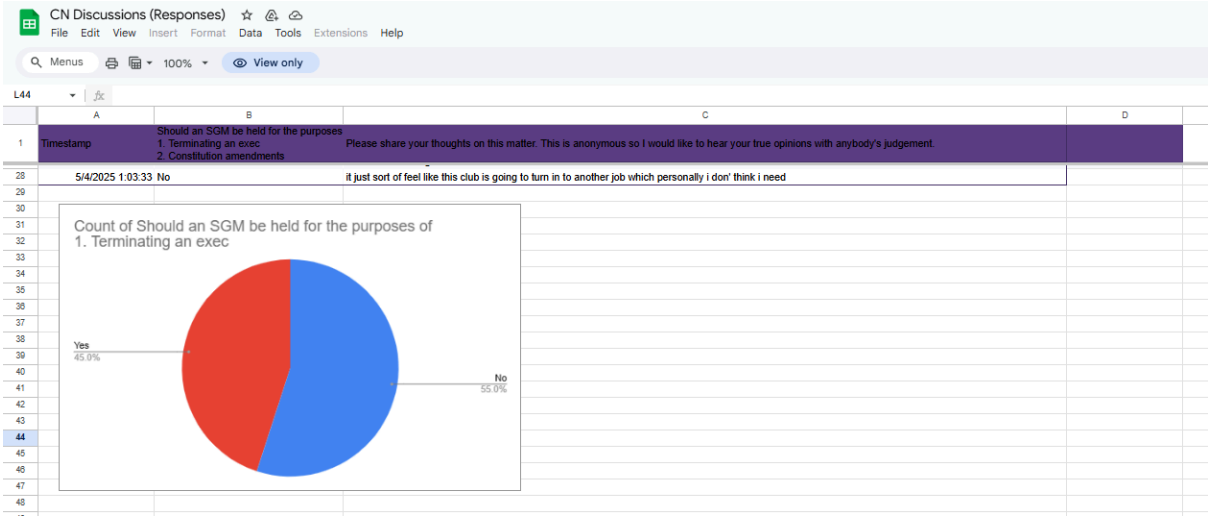
The form responses show a few responses providing written feedback, they largely align with rejecting the Special General Meeting, indicating either an influenced perspective or limited opposition. The structure of the survey itself likely shaped the responses, reinforcing the President's stance rather than fostering genuine discussion.



CN Discussions (Responses)

Timestamp	Should an SGM be held for the purposes: 1. Terminating an exec 2. Constitution amendments	Please share your thoughts on this matter. This is anonymous so I would like to hear your true opinions with anybody's judgement.
5/2/2025 15:15:19	No	
5/2/2025 15:15:23	No	God I hope zac isn't president next year beacuse i might just have to save my $10
5/2/2025 15:15:25	Yes	For terminating an exec, please find a way to make it anonymous
5/2/2025 15:15:54	Yes	
5/2/2025 15:16:32	No	
5/2/2025 15:16:50	Yes	I think it's inconsequential either way. If we terminate the exec we don't really take a hit and if the exec hasn't really taken an interest in the club either way so they don't really get affected either.
5/2/2025 15:17:43	Yes	In response to the two proposed points: 1. Execs are expected to uphold their responsibilities as assigned under the role descriptions document and under the constitution. Given the related executive's inability to fulfill these roles and communicate with the team, I do not believe it is right that this person retains their elected responsibility. 2. Constitution amendments are a good thing to be discussed as a team, but there is nothing that stops any member of the club (not just the executive) from proposing amendments and for these amendments (once approved by the Guild) from being approved (or rejected) by the members at an A/SGM. In both of these cases, it is up to the members to decide whether motions are suitable to be agreed to. We should not be preventing our members from being aware of issues within the executive and from expressing their views on these.
5/2/2025 15:24:22	No	
5/2/2025 15:35:49	Yes	I think it's fair to terminate the exec (not fair if we don't for the other execs) SGM might be good for the coordinator roles, for the formalities
5/2/2025 15:36:15	No	
5/2/2025 15:37:49	Yes	While this club is volunteer, student-run, there are still processes and procedures that need to be followed to ensure the smooth operations of the club. If an executive is not fulfilling their "willful" duties to the club, there should be reprimands and consequences to this. Additionally, programming and code development cannot be efficient without CI/CD, if we leave the amendment in a position where it is not effective or efficient, we cannot improve and continue to provide a safe, supportive environment for our members.
5/2/2025 16:29:29	Yes	
5/2/2025 17:32:56	No	I think it is important to be empathetic with our fellow execs. We are all volunteers who do this not for money or power but because we love this community, and this is a gift we should not take for granted. Being an executive is an opportunity for the individual and an opportunity for the members, not a job. And if it becomes a job w There are many valid reasons why we may not accomplish as much as others because a coding university club (it's important to remember that's what this is) is far from the sole focus of our lives, and it doesn't prevent others from making their own contributions. Termination should be the last resort for cases of active harm, but there is no evidence of this and we have an incredible team that is comically large and very well positioned to cultivate this awesome community. Code Network is in a great place and we gain nothing by terminating one of our fellow execs. Instead, we lose out on tl I ask that we please do not give up on each other so easily. We are for our members but we are also for each other because we are all members of this community. And although constitutional amendments are certainly needed sometimes, they also should not be rushed, otherwise its words do not have staying power and it is not a constitution. The constitution is meant to move slowly and ensure we adhere to the mission of this club. Just take some more time for deliberation together as a te
5/2/2025 18:08:16	No	I dont know i think its a bit too far to remove someone
5/2/2025 22:43:53	Yes	
5/2/2025 22:48:15	Yes	The emotional journey I went on during the meeting. I laughed. I cried. I found inner peace.
5/2/2025 22:56:08	Yes	Discuss we need this SGM. Accountability? Okay. Constitutional revamp? Double okay.
5/2/2025 22:59:26	Yes	Let's gooooooo _ finally some? _ executive chaos? _ to spice up my semester.
5/2/2025 22:57:19	Yes	Vote yes. Not for justice. Not for change. But because this is messier than Love Island and I'm bored.
5/2/2025 23:00:12	Yes	SGM stands for "Silly Goose Mode" and I'm enabling it. Honk honk
5/2/2025 23:00:49	Yes	I support the SGM, but only if the exec gets voted off like in Survivor. "The tribe has spoken."
5/2/2025 23:03:07	Yes	This shall be known as The Good Exec Purge of 2025. Let the scrolls be amended and the tea spilled.
5/2/2025 23:01:30	Yes	This is the political drama I signed up for. Please livestream it with dramatic sound effects.
5/2/2025 23:09:04	No	
5/2/2025 23:17:10	No	
5/3/2025 11:14:37	No	Could be more organized.
5/4/2025 1:03:33	No	ill just sort of feel like this club is going to turn in to another job which personally i don' think i need

This is an SGM requisition to remove Subiksha Thiyagarajan from the position of Code Network President.



Impact

Deliberate Data Exclusion

- Votes in favour of holding the SGM were purposefully removed, misrepresenting the full spectrum of member opinions.
- This selective exclusion skews the results to favour a predetermined outcome aligned with the president's views.
- By sidelining legitimate feedback, it undermines the integrity of the democratic process within the club.

Presentation and Framing Bias

- The layout of the spreadsheet—with highlighted responses and detailed comments—can draw disproportionate attention to certain opinions over others.
- The President deliberately disregarded the red responses in the attached image. Such framing reinforces a narrative that supports the president's agenda, subtly influencing reader interpretation and member perception
- Setting a Precedent for Bias: Her selective omission not only manipulates the vote outcome but also sets a dangerous precedent, signaling that deviation from established constitutional norms is acceptable if it serves a personal agenda.

Contextual and Confirmation Bias

- The overall presentation of data in the image reinforces a context where dissenting opinions are devalued, confirming the bias of those in power.
- The anonymity of responses may lead to oversimplified conclusions that ignore the nuances behind each executive's perspective.
- This environment encourages leaders to selectively use feedback that corroborates their stance, further entrenching the bias in governance decisions.

Lack of Action in Organizing an SGM for Coordinator Replacements

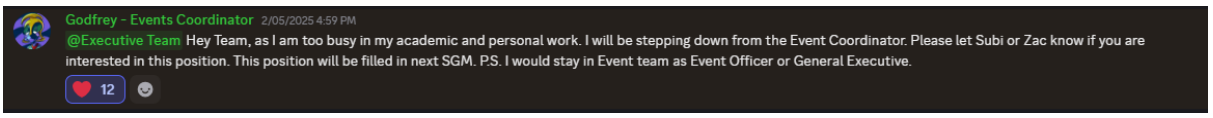
Explanation

In a critical oversight, the President did not take steps to call an SGM to address the urgent need for replacements in the Marketing and Event Coordinator roles. With major events like the Hackathon and Tech Industry Night approaching, the absence of a formal handover between outgoing and incoming executives jeopardized the club's operational preparedness. Despite the outgoing Marketing Coordinator expressing a clear willingness to facilitate a structured transition, the lack of action from the President meant no formal process was put in place, leaving the club without a clear leadership transition.

Both Millah and Godfrey had been prepared to ensure a well-organized handover, yet without an SGM, there was no opportunity for this to be properly implemented. The President's inaction failed to address the club's immediate needs, undermining governance and placing the club at a strategic disadvantage as its most significant events of the year drew near.

Evidence

Godfrey, the Events Coordinator, makes his announcement clear—his academic and personal workload has forced him to step down. His message is direct, offering no room for hesitation: the position will be filled at the next Special General Meeting.



The Full Team meeting on Friday, 02/05/2025, captured key discussions surrounding club operations, leadership transitions, and constitutional amendments. The conversation naturally led to the topic of a Special General Meeting (SGM), with the Vice President raising the need for a Marketing Coordinator and Godfrey's potential resignation from the Events Coordinator role reinforcing the urgency. The team acknowledged that an SGM would be necessary to formally address these vacancies, ensuring a structured transition. An email had already been sent to the guild proposing the SGM and constitutional changes,

signaling an intent to move forward. However, despite these discussions, the meeting minutes reflect uncertainty—while the need for an SGM was recognized, the next steps remained unclear, leaving the club's leadership in a precarious position as major events approached.

In this situation, both Millah and Godfrey have formally announced their resignations, leaving critical executive roles unfilled. According to the constitution, the President is required to call a General Meeting to ensure these vacancies are properly addressed. However, the refusal to do so directly contradicts the governance framework, undermining the club's ability to maintain operational stability.

15. TERMINATION OF THE TERMS OF THE EXECUTIVE MEMBERS

15.1. An Executive Member will cease to hold their position:

- 15.1.1. If they cease to be a Student; or
- 15.1.2. By a resolution passed by a two-thirds (⅔) majority at a GM; or
- 15.1.3. If they resign from the Executive or the Club; or
- 15.1.4. Upon the appointment of a new Executive in accordance with clause 13.0.

CODE NETWORK | CONSTITUTION 7

15.2. In the event an Executive position is left vacant after an Executive Member ceases to hold their position, a GM must be called to elect a new Executive Member in the vacant position.

Impact

Critical Oversight in Succession Planning:

- The President refused to call an SGM despite an urgent need to replace the Marketing and Event Coordinator roles.
- This significant oversight undermines the club's ability to continuously renew its leadership at a time when proactive measures are most needed.

Risk to Operational Preparedness:

- With key events like the Hackathon and Tech Industry Night fast approaching, the absence of a formal transition process jeopardizes the club's overall operational readiness.
- Without a proper handover, the official shift of responsibilities cannot occur. Those supporting this position will not be equipped with the necessary skills or guidance to execute these roles effectively.

Resistance to Established Transition Processes:

- Despite the current Marketing Coordinator's wants to facilitate a formal handover, the President's refusal to do so signals a reluctance to adopt best practices in succession planning.
- This resistance not only affects team cohesion but also highlights a failure to recognise the importance of established governance procedures for smooth leadership transitions.

Strategic Disadvantage and Long-Term Implications:

- The decision to forego an SGM leaves the club at a strategic disadvantage, as a delayed or poorly managed transition can have ripple effects on both short-term event success and long-term organizational stability.
- Without urgent action to fill these leadership roles, critical gaps in management may emerge, undermining confidence among team members and stakeholders.